



Proposed CEA Link — December 2026

How this rota would work from December 2026, and how it compares with today's link

Prepared 2 October 2026 · every figure is calculated from the rota, not entered by hand

PROPOSAL

Polished Clean

Weekday closers from 16:25, with twelve on a Saturday

CODE **PC-24-EXT**

FINGERPRINT **12424ed2**

SET AGAINST today's 20-week link

CREATED 28 September 2026

IN SHORT

Polished Clean stays inside every hard limit but meets only 4 of the 9 December staffing rules; one more is waived for it. For staff, the biggest gains are never more than 6 days in a row in the fixed duties (today 7) and shorter weekday and Saturday closing shifts. The main trade-offs are fewer full weekends off (about 4 a year, today 10) and more six-day weeks (5, today 1).

For discussion, not a decision. This proposal has not yet been through the roster office or a union rep. Still to settle: which link is used — colleagues' views come first — and then who starts on which line; the rota does not say who works which week.

What it takes: 24 people, 4 more than today's 20 · 4 cover weeks for leave and sickness · 10 on duty every Sunday (today 8; the rules ask for 10) — 85h 50m of Sunday overtime across the whole link each week (today 68h 15m).

Can it work?

Does it meet the December staffing rules?

4 of 9

met — four not met, one waived
today's link meets 4 · each rule on page 6

Can it be run within the hard limits?

Yes

inside every hard limit
shortest gap 13h 50m (limit 12h) · most days in a row 6, up to 9 if a cover week falls badly (limit 13) · 35-hour contract exact

Any avoidable fatigue warnings?

2

avoidable warnings in the fixed duties
too little rest after a run of early starts and start times that jump by more than two hours · today's link has 4 · up to 5 (today 5) if a cover week falls badly · guidance, not a pass or fail · page 7

Does staffing follow the trains better?

Mostly

closer than today — less close on Thursday
weekdays 35.9 (today 52.0) · Sat 52.9 (65.9) · Sun 69.6 (71.7) · on weekdays a score about two-thirds of today's · page 5

The four December rules it does not meet

- ✗ At least four on at the open, every day — here 4 · 5 · 3
- ✗ At least five still on duty at 22:00, every day — here 5-6 · 5 · 4

- ✗ Sunday duties between 8h and 9h — here 8h 00m-9h 05m
- ✗ No more shift times than today — here 19

Waived for this design (agreed by the owner, 30 September 2026): The ticket office: two early and two late, identical shifts, every day — here the office is run as its author planned it, not as identical pairs — the shifts for each day are on page 5.

What it would mean for staff

Likely positives for staff

- Never more than 6 days in a row in the fixed duties (today 7)
- Shorter weekday and Saturday closing shifts
- The average shift 11 minutes shorter
- Shortest rest between shifts 13h 50m (today 12h 30m)
- Fewer fatigue warnings in the fixed duties — 2 (today 4)

More detail on page 2

What colleagues may be concerned about

- Fewer full weekends off — about 4 a year (today 10), 2 in 24 weeks, up to 14 weeks apart (today 7)
- More six-day weeks — 5 (today 1)
- More single rest days, which are not a two-day break — 16 (today 4)
- About 5 more contracted days at work a year
- More late finishes — about 50 a year each (today 39)
- Some longer Sunday closing shifts
- Worse than today on too little rest after a run of early starts (5, today 2) and start times that jump by more than two hours (7, today 6)
- A worked cover week could make a 55-hour week (page 7)
- Start times move further from week to week — 4h 47m (today 4h 00m)
- 10 new shift times to learn

What changes, in numbers

Today's 20-week link beside Polished Clean. ✓ **green**: better than today on something the rules, the hard limits or the fatigue guidance aim for · ▲ **amber**: worse on one of those · ✗ **red**: a rule or limit broken · **unshaded**: a difference for colleagues to weigh.

QUESTION	TODAY	POLISHED CLEAN	IN PLAIN WORDS
STAFFING			
People on the link	20	24	4 more people, one per line
On duty each day weekday · Sat · Sun	11·12 · 10 · 8	✓ 13·16 · 12 · 10	the December levels ask for 10 on a Sunday — met
On at the open weekday · Sat · Sun	4 · 4 · 3	✗ 4 · 5 · 3	at least 4 every day — not met
Still on duty at 22:00 weekday · Sat · Sun	4 · 2 · 3	✗ 5·6 · 5 · 4	at least 5 every day — not met
Through to the close weekday · Sat · Sun	2 · 2 · 3	✓ 3·4 · 3 · 4	at least 3 every day — met
How closely the floor follows the trains weekday · Sat · Sun	52.0 · 65.9 · 71.7	✓ 35.9 · 52.9 · 69.6	lower is closer; weekdays about two-thirds of today's — page 5
Cover weeks — for leave and sickness	lines 1, 7, 12, 17	lines 1, 7, 12, 17	gaps of 6, 5, 5 and 8 weeks
Ticket office late shift on a Sunday — people	1	1	the December plan has two; this design keeps one, a 14:20–23:25, in the office until 22:30 — as today's 14:30–23:25 closer does
WORKING PATTERN			
Most days in a row, fixed duties	7	✓ 6	up to 9 (today 9) if a cover week falls badly; Chiltern's limit is 13
Shortest gap between two shifts	12h 30m	✓ 13h 50m	in the fixed duties; the limit is 12 hours
Full weekends off, in the rotation	4 in 20	▲ 2 in 24	uneven: never more than 14 weeks apart (today 7)
Days at work a year, not counting Sundays	219	224	Sundays are overtime; a cover week counts as 4 days
Weeks on one shift time	7 of 16	7 of 20	all earlies or all lates, one clock time Monday to Friday
Weeks mixing earlies and lates	7 of 16	3 of 20	a week with both early and late shifts in it
Single rest days	4	16	a rest day on its own — not a two-day break
Six-day weeks	1	5	weeks with six days at work, Sundays counted
SHIFTS			
Average shift · longest shift	8h 14m · 9h 10m	8h 03m · 9h 05m	the average is Monday to Saturday; the longest is on any day
Early shifts, shortest to longest	7h 15m–8h 30m	7h 15m–8h 30m	an early starts before 11:00 · any day of the week
Late shifts, shortest to longest	7h 30m–9h 10m	7h 30m–9h 05m	a late starts at 11:00 or after · any day of the week
Closing shift weekday · Sat · Sun	8h 40m · 9h 10m · 8h 55m	7h 30m · 8h 40m · 8h 55m–9h 05m	the shift that locks up
How far the start time moves from one week to the next — on average	4h 00m	▲ 4h 47m	smaller is easier on the body clock
Different shift times	18	✗ 19 (9 worked today)	10 new to learn, on 18 of the 20 working weeks — listed on page 4
EACH PERSON'S YEAR, ON AVERAGE			
Full weekends off	10	▲ 4	8% of weeks (today 20%)
Finishing at 23:00 or later	39	50	about one extra every 5 weeks
Starting at 06:20, the open	62	54	about one fewer every 6 or 7 weeks
Saturdays worked	26	26	a rostered Saturday is paid at time and a quarter; cover weeks not counted
Sunday overtime to share	21	22	Sundays are overtime, as today
FATIGUE AND THE RULES			
Avoidable fatigue warnings, fixed duties	4	✓ 2	up to 5 (today 5) if a cover week falls badly, one a 55-hour week; guidance only, page 7
December staffing rules met	4 of 9	✗ 4 of 9	confirmed verbally, 29 Sep 2026; one more waived for this design — page 6

The workings: the rota (page 3) · shift times (4) · staffing through the day (5) · the rules (6) · fatigue checks (7) · can I trust these numbers? (8)

THE ROTA

The 24-line link

Sunday to Saturday per line; everyone moves down one line each week and line 24 goes back to line 1. Hours and days at the right; the number on duty each day beneath.

20 working weeks · 4 cover weeks · 35h 00m a week on average · at most 6 days in a row (9 if a cover week falls badly) · 7 weeks on one shift time

LINE	SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	MON-SAT hours	ALL WEEK hours	DAYS WORKED Mon-Sat	TURNS Mon-Fri
1	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	35h 00m	35h 00m	—	—
2	14:30 23:25	16:25 23:55	16:25 23:55	16:25 23:55	16:25 23:55	RD	RD	30h 00m	38h 55m	4	1
3	10:30 19:00	RD	08:30 16:30	06:20 14:20	06:20 14:20	06:20 14:20	06:20 14:30	40h 10m	48h 40m	5	2
4	RD	RD	06:20 14:20	08:30 16:30	RD	16:25 23:55	15:15 23:55	32h 10m	32h 10m	4	3
5	RD	12:00 20:30	14:00 22:30	14:00 22:30	14:00 22:30	16:25 23:55	RD	41h 30m	41h 30m	5	3
6	RD	06:20 14:20	07:00 15:30	07:00 15:30	07:00 15:30	08:30 17:00	RD	42h 00m	42h 00m	5	3
7	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	35h 00m	35h 00m	—	—
8	07:15 15:45	06:20 13:45	RD	RD	13:30 22:00	14:00 22:30	15:15 23:55	33h 05m	41h 35m	4	3
9	RD	16:25 23:55	16:25 23:55	16:25 23:55	16:25 23:55	16:25 23:55	14:30 22:30	45h 30m	45h 30m	6	1
10	RD	RD	12:00 20:30	12:00 20:30	12:00 20:30	12:00 20:30	RD	34h 00m	34h 00m	4	1
11	08:30 16:30	07:00 15:30	07:00 15:30	RD	RD	06:20 13:35	06:20 14:30	32h 25m	40h 25m	4	2
12	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	35h 00m	35h 00m	—	—
13	14:20 23:25	RD	14:00 22:30	14:00 22:30	14:00 22:30	14:00 22:30	14:00 22:30	42h 30m	51h 35m	5	1
14	RD	14:00 22:30	16:25 23:55	RD	RD	07:00 15:30	06:20 14:30	32h 40m	32h 40m	4	3
15	07:15 15:45	RD	06:20 13:35	06:20 13:35	06:20 13:35	07:00 15:30	RD	30h 15m	38h 45m	4	2
16	RD	06:20 13:45	08:30 17:00	08:30 17:00	RD	RD	RD	24h 25m	24h 25m	3	2
17	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	35h 00m	35h 00m	—	—
18	07:15 15:45	06:20 13:45	06:20 13:45	RD	06:20 14:20	06:20 14:20	06:20 14:30	39h 00m	47h 30m	5	2
19	13:30 21:30	13:30 22:00	RD	RD	13:30 22:00	13:30 22:00	13:30 21:30	33h 30m	41h 30m	4	1
20	RD	08:30 17:00	RD	06:20 13:45	06:20 13:45	06:20 13:45	RD	30h 45m	30h 45m	4	2
21	14:30 23:25	RD	RD	13:30 21:30	13:30 21:30	13:30 21:30	13:30 21:30	32h 00m	40h 55m	4	1
22	RD	14:00 22:30	13:30 22:00	13:30 22:00	13:30 22:00	RD	RD	34h 00m	34h 00m	4	2
23	14:30 23:25	16:25 23:55	RD	16:25 23:55	16:25 23:55	16:25 23:55	15:15 23:55	38h 40m	47h 35m	5	1
24	RD	RD	06:20 13:45	06:20 13:45	08:30 17:00	RD	06:20 14:25	31h 25m	31h 25m	4	2
On duty	10 SP 4	13 SP 4	15 SP 4	15 SP 4	16 SP 4	16 SP 4	12 SP 4	35h 00m	38h 35m	4.35	7 one-turn weeks
Minutes	5,150	6,225	7,205	7,175	7,750	7,690	5,955	42,000	47,150		

Early turns Late turns Cover (spare) week — four duties of seven, any turn Rest day

Mon-Sat hours average 35h 00m over 24 lines, a cover week counted as a contracted week · days worked average over the 20 working lines · Turns: how many different shift times the week works Monday to Friday; **bold** marks a one-turn week (see below) · Minutes: total duty minutes each day — Monday to Saturday adds up to the contract (35 hours for each of the 20 working weeks = 42,000 minutes)

The words on this page

Link — the whole rota: 24 weeks laid out as 24 lines. Everyone works line 1, then line 2, and so on round the wheel; the link needs 24 people.

Line — one week of the pattern, Sunday to Saturday. Everyone moves down a line each week, and line 24 goes back to line 1.

Turn — a shift time, such as 06:20–13:35. An **early** starts before 11:00; a **late** starts at 11:00 or later.

Rest day (RD) — a day off inside the contracted week. Two together make a proper break; one on its own does not count as a 48-hour break.

Cover (spare) week — a week with no fixed times. Whoever is on it works four duties of the seven days, placed by the roster clerk to cover leave and sickness.

Sunday — not part of the contract. A Sunday duty is rest-day working, paid on top of the week, which is why the hours are shown Mon-Sat and all week.

The contract — 35 hours a week, averaged over the 24 lines; a cover week counts as a full contracted week.

One-turn week — one clock time Monday to Friday, with every day of the week an early or every day a late (shown bold in the Turns column); the easiest kind of week to live around.

The floor — staff out on the station (gates, concourse, platforms); the ticket office joins it only at the quiet ends (page 5).

Opener / closer — the first people on duty in the morning and the last at night.

Shift times

The shift times staff would need to learn, every shift time beside the ones worked today, and the shape of a working week.

19

shift times in all

9

already worked today

10

are new — nobody works them today

The new times to learn

06:20–14:25

8h 05m · early · Saturdays

06:20–14:30

8h 10m · early · Saturdays

07:00–15:30

8h 30m · early · weekdays

08:30–17:00

8h 30m · early · weekdays

10:30–19:00

8h 30m · early · Sundays

12:00–20:30

8h 30m · late · weekdays

13:30–21:30

8h 00m · late · weekdays, Saturdays and Sundays

14:20–23:25

9h 05m · late · Sundays

14:30–22:30

8h 00m · late · Saturdays

16:25–23:55

7h 30m · late · weekdays

No longer used: 9 of today's 18 shift times — 06:20–14:00, 06:20–14:50, 08:00–16:30, 11:00–19:30, 12:00–20:00, 13:00–21:00, 13:30–21:00, 14:30–22:00, 14:45–23:55.

Every shift time, beside today's

		TODAY'S LINK			PROPOSED		
SHIFT TIME		MON-FRI	SAT	SUN	MON-FRI	SAT	SUN
06:20–13:35	7h 15m · Early	1		1			
06:20–13:45	7h 25m · Early	1		3 (+2)			
06:20–14:00	DROPPED 7h 40m · Early		1		0 (–1)		
06:20–14:20	8h 00m · Early	2		2			
06:20–14:25	NEW 8h 05m · Early				1 (+1)		
06:20–14:30	NEW 8h 10m · Early				4 (+4)		
06:20–14:50	DROPPED 8h 30m · Early		3		0 (–3)		
07:00–15:30	NEW 8h 30m · Early			2 (+2)			
07:15–15:45	8h 30m · Early			3			3
08:00–16:30	DROPPED 8h 30m · Early	2		0 (–2)			
08:30–16:30	8h 00m · Early			1	1 (+1)		1
08:30–17:00	NEW 8h 30m · Early			1 (+1)			
10:30–19:00	NEW 8h 30m · Early						1 (+1)
11:00–19:30	DROPPED 8h 30m · Late	1		0 (–1)			
12:00–20:00	DROPPED 8h 00m · Late		1		0 (–1)		
12:00–20:30	NEW 8h 30m · Late			1 (+1)			
13:00–21:00	DROPPED 8h 00m · Late			1			0 (–1)
13:30–21:00	DROPPED 7h 30m · Late		1		0 (–1)		
13:30–21:30	NEW 8h 00m · Late			1 (+1)	2 (+2)		1 (+1)
13:30–22:00	8h 30m · Late	1		3 (+2)			
14:00–22:30	8h 30m · Late	2		2	1 (+1)		
14:20–23:25	NEW 9h 05m · Late						1 (+1)
14:30–22:00	DROPPED 7h 30m · Late		2		0 (–2)		
14:30–22:30	NEW 8h 00m · Late				1 (+1)		
14:30–23:25	8h 55m · Late			3			3
14:45–23:55	DROPPED 9h 10m · Late		2		0 (–2)		
15:15–23:55	8h 40m · Late	2		0 (–2)	3 (+3)		
16:25–23:55	NEW 7h 30m · Late			4 (+4)			

People on each shift time on a Saturday, a Sunday and — under Mon–Fri — the weekday with most of that time, so Mon–Fri can add up to more than work on one day. **(+2)** and **(–1)**: more or fewer people on that time than today — a difference, not a verdict. **New**: nobody works it today. **Dropped**: worked today, not in this link.

Monday to Friday add up to 36,045 minutes of duty and Saturday 5,955 — together exactly 42,000 minutes — 35 hours for each of the 20 working weeks, the contract (a cover week counts as a full 35-hour week on top). Sunday adds 5,150, paid on top of the contracted week. 10 of the 19 shift times are new — nobody works them today.

The shape of a week

MEASURE	TODAY	PROPOSED	IN PLAIN WORDS
Rest breaks of two days or more	13 of 17	13 of 29	of all the breaks between duties
Single rest days	4 (1 beside a cover week)	16 (1 beside a cover week)	one beside a cover week depends on where its four duties fall
Working weeks by days worked, Sunday in	1 × 3-day, 3 × 4-day, 11 × 5-day, 1 × 6-day	1 × 3-day, 6 × 4-day, 8 × 5-day, 5 × 6-day	cover weeks left out
Working weeks with a Sunday	8 of 16	10 of 20	the number on duty each Sunday — all overtime

STAFFING THROUGH THE DAY

People on duty, hour by hour

Today's link and the proposal, hour by hour, against the December 2026 timetable. A darker orange hour carries more of the day's trains.

How closely the floor follows the trains

Today's link

Weekdays

52.0

Saturday

65.9

Sunday

71.7

Polished Clean

✓ 35.9

✓ 52.9

✓ 69.6

The floor follows the trains more closely than today — scores weekdays about two-thirds of today's, Saturday about four-fifths of today's, Sunday about the same as today's. Lower is closer; 0 is a perfect match.

People on duty in that hour — darker blue is more. Anyone on for any part of the hour counts, so a handover counts both people.

Trains — carriages arriving and leaving in that hour; darker is busier. A guide from the timetable, not passenger numbers.

Read down each column: the most people should be under the darkest orange.

Strongest rows: the floor and the trains — the two the match compares.

Monday to Friday staffed 06:20–23:55 · a row for each different weekday

	05	06	07	08	09	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	Match
Today, Mon · Wed — all on duty		4	4	6	6	6	7	7	7	7	7	7	5	5	5	4	4	4	2	
Today, Tue · Thu · Fri — all on duty		4	4	6	6	6	7	7	8	8	8	8	6	6	6	5	5	4	2	
of whom in the ticket office		1	1	2	2	2	2	2	2	4	2	2	2	2	1	1	1	1		
of whom on the floor Mon · Wed		3	3	4	4	4	5	5	5	3	5	5	3	3	4	3	3	3	2	61.1
of whom on the floor Tue · Thu · Fri		3	3	4	4	4	5	5	6	4	6	6	4	4	5	4	4	3	2	50.1
Proposed, Mon — all on duty		4	5	6	6	6	6	7	8	7	6	8	7	7	7	7	6	5	3	
Proposed, Tue — all on duty		4	6	8	8	8	8	9	10	9	8	9	7	7	7	7	6	5	3	
Proposed, Wed — all on duty		4	5	7	7	7	7	8	10	9	8	10	8	8	8	8	7	5	3	
Proposed, Thu — all on duty		4	5	6	6	6	6	7	11	11	9	11	10	10	10	10	9	5	3	
Proposed, Fri — all on duty		4	6	7	7	7	7	8	10	10	8	10	9	9	9	9	8	6	4	
of whom in the ticket office		1	1	2	2	2	2	2	3	4	3	2	2	2	1	1	1	1		
of whom on the floor Mon		3	4	4	4	4	4	5	5	3	3	6	5	5	6	6	5	4	3	36.0
of whom on the floor Tue		3	5	6	6	6	6	7	7	5	5	7	5	5	6	6	5	4	3	41.2
of whom on the floor Wed		3	4	5	5	5	5	6	7	5	5	8	6	6	7	7	6	4	3	37.6
of whom on the floor Thu		3	4	4	4	4	4	5	8	7	6	9	8	8	9	9	8	4	3	70.6
of whom on the floor Fri		3	5	5	5	5	5	6	7	6	5	8	7	7	8	8	7	5	4	35.7
Trains — carriages in and out	5	69	107	127	122	95	85	75	84	79	87	105	140	138	107	90	73	75	66	

Saturday staffed 06:20–23:55

	05	06	07	08	09	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	Match
Today — all on duty		4	4	4	4	4	4	5	6	9	6	6	6	6	6	5	4	2	2	
of whom in the ticket office		1	1	2	2	2	2	2	2	4	2	2	2	2	1	1	1			
of whom on the floor		3	3	2	2	2	2	3	4	5	4	4	4	4	5	4	3	2	2	65.9
Proposed — all on duty		5	5	5	5	5	5	5	7	9	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	5	3	
of whom in the ticket office		1	1	2	2	2	2	2	3	4	2	2	2	2	1	1	1			
of whom on the floor		4	4	3	3	3	3	3	4	5	5	5	5	5	6	6	6	5	3	52.9
Trains — carriages in and out	6	24	58	75	81	92	88	77	64	68	72	84	82	67	64	79	78	62	41	

Sunday staffed 07:15–23:25

	05	06	07	08	09	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	Match
Today — all on duty			3	4	4	4	4	4	5	8	8	5	4	4	4	4	3	3	3	
of whom in the ticket office			1	1	2	2	2	2	2	3	3	1	1	1	1	1	1	1		
of whom on the floor			2	3	2	2	2	2	3	5	5	4	3	3	3	3	2	2	3	71.7
Proposed — all on duty			3	4	4	5	5	5	6	10	10	7	6	6	5	5	5	4	4	
of whom in the ticket office			1	2	2	2	2	2	2	3	3	2	1	1	1	1	1			
of whom on the floor			2	2	2	3	3	3	4	7	7	5	5	5	4	4	4	4	4	69.6
Trains — carriages in and out			15	45	65	71	74	71	61	55	64	69	78	73	75	52	71	65	50	

Good to know

- The ticket office.** As this design's author planned it. Monday to Friday a 06:20–14:20 opens the office and a 07:00–15:30 joins at 08:00, on the floor until then; a 13:30–22:00 and a 14:00–22:30 take over, the 13:30 on the floor from 19:30. Saturday two 06:20–14:30s, one on the floor until 08:00, then a 13:30–21:30, on the floor from 19:30, and a 14:00–22:30 until 22:00. Not identical pairs: a rule waived for this design. The “of whom” rows take these people out of each side, so the floor rows compare like with like.
- Sunday.** A 07:15–15:45 opens the office and an 08:30–16:30 joins it; a 14:20–23:25 takes over from 14:20 and keeps it until 22:30, then joins the floor — one late, as today, where the December plan has two. Today one 14:30–23:25 closer keeps the office until 22:30.
- Reading the match.** The weekday figure at the top is worked out from the five weekdays together, not averaged from the day scores. It measures **shape, not numbers** — each hour's share of the day's staff against its share of the day's trains — so an extra person in a quiet hour makes it worse even though nobody is worse off. Read it beside the numbers of people, never alone.
- Cover weeks.** They are not in these figures, because their times are not known yet; actual staffing depends on where those duties are used.
- Sunday's last trains.** On Sundays five trains in the December 2026 timetable arrive or leave after the 23:25 finish (the last at 23:54); the bar under the Sunday 23:00 hour marks the time after the finish. No duty runs past 23:25 on a Sunday — that is agreed practice and stays so (settled 28 Sep 2026) — so those trains fall outside the staffed day of any link, today's included.

THE RULES

Hard limits and the December 2026 rules

Three hard limits a rota must meet to be run at all, then the nine December 2026 staffing rules, each with today's link beside it.

Hard limits — met, or the rota cannot be run

MOST DAYS IN A ROW

9

✓ met · longest possible · limit 13 · today 9 · fixed duties 6 (today 7)

Longest possible run is 9 days, within Chiltern's limit of 13. A cover week is 4 duties in 7 days and the roster clerk places them, so this is the worst case the link allows. Worked as a block of four rather than split day-on-day-off, the worst case is the same — 9 days. It does depend on where the roster clerk puts the four: placed well, the longest run is 6 days.
The written source of the 13-day limit is still to be confirmed.

SHORTEST REST BETWEEN SHIFTS

13h 50m

✓ met · in the fixed duties · limit 12h · today 12h 30m

Tightest anywhere: 13h 50m — line 3 Tue 08:30–16:30 into Wed 06:20–14:20 (today's tightest: 12h 30m).

THE 35-HOUR CONTRACT

35h 00m

✓ met · a week, Monday to Saturday, on average · must be exact

700h of duty a week across 20 working lines. Sunday duties (85h 50m in all) are paid on top as rest-day working, as they are today. Individual weeks range 24h 25m–45h 30m; only the average is the contract.

The December 2026 rules

× 4 of 9 met — 4 not met, shaded below; 1 waived for this design

RULE	TODAY'S LINK	THIS PROPOSAL	WHAT THE RULE ASKS
At least four on at the open, every day	× 4 · 4 · 3	× 4 · 5 · 3	from 06:20 (07:15 on a Sunday)
At least three through to the close, every day	× 2 · 2 · 3	✓ 3–4 · 3 · 4	until 23:55 (23:25 on a Sunday)
At least five still on duty at 22:00, every day	× 4 · 2 · 3	× 5–6 · 5 · 4	someone finishing at 22:00 does not count
Ten on a Sunday	× 8	✓ 10	every duty rostered that day counts
The ticket office: two early and two late, identical shifts, every day	× Mon–Fri yes · Sat yes · Sun no	○ waived — Mon–Fri no · Sat no · Sun no	Mon–Fri 06:20–14:20 and 14:00–22:30; Sat 06:20–14:50 and 14:30–22:00; Sun two from 07:15 and two to 22:30
At least two on the floor at every moment	✓ fewest 2 · 2 · 2 — first at Mon 22:30, Sat 08:00, Sun 07:15	✓ fewest 2 · 2 · 2 — first at Mon 13:45, Sat 14:30, Sun 07:15	the ticket office counts only while its staff are on the floor — at the quiet ends and once the office has closed, as this design runs it; checked every five minutes
Handovers: 15 minutes to each closer, 20 in the ticket office (30 on a Sunday)	✓ floor met · ticket office 20 min	✓ floor met · ticket office 60 min	the ticket office overlap is from its first late arriving to its last early leaving, as this design runs it; on a Sunday each opener also stays until 15 minutes after the last closer arrives
Sunday duties between 8h and 9h	✓ 8h 00m–8h 55m	× 8h 00m–9h 05m	every Sunday duty, start to finish
No more shift times than today	✓ 18	× 19	today 18

Fatigue checks

From the Office of Rail and Road's good-practice guidance, *Fatigue Factors*, page 3 (December 2021): 21 roster patterns that tend to tire people, with 4 checks from the rail industry's fatigue guidance (MRSF). ▲ present — worth a look, not a breach · ✓ clear · ● standing — comes with the station's hours or any weekly link.

AVOIDABLE FATIGUE WARNINGS

2 in the fixed duties · today's link has 4 · up to 5 (today 5) if a cover week falls badly · each is a question to discuss, not a breach

STANDING — COME WITH EVERY WEEKLY LINK

2 early starts at a 06:20 station, and a rotation that moves everyone one line a week · recorded, not counted

For each of the 25 patterns this table asks whether it is in the rotation, today and proposed, and how big it is. A design showing nothing is not thereby approved: this is guidance, not a fatigue risk assessment.

PATTERN	TODAY'S LINK	PROPOSED
Early starts, 05:00 to 06:59 FF2 · Early shift starting 05:00 to 06:59 · Time of day	● 24	● 25
Very early starts, before 05:00 FF3 · Very early shift starting before 05:00 · Time of day	✓ 0	✓ 0
Shifts over 12 hours FF5 · Day shift over 12h · Duty length	✓ 0	✓ 0
Early shifts over 10 hours FF7 · Early shift over 10h · Duty length	✓ 0	✓ 0
Too little rest after a run of early starts FF8b · Fewer than 2 days rest after a block of early starts · Recovery time	▲ 2 ▲ up to 3 if a cover week falls badly	▲ 5 ▲ up to 6 if a cover week falls badly
Too many shifts without a two-day break FF11 · More than 13 consecutive shifts without a 48h break · Recovery time	✓ 8 ✓ up to 12 if a cover week falls badly	✓ 9 ▲ up to 14 if a cover week falls badly
Runs of 12-hour day shifts FF10 · More than 4 consecutive 12h day shifts · Cumulative	✓ 0	✓ 0
Long runs of early shifts FF15 · More than 4 consecutive early shifts in a rotating pattern · Cumulative	▲ 5 ▲ up to 6 if a cover week falls badly	✓ 4 ▲ up to 6 if a cover week falls badly
Long runs of day shifts MRSF · More than 12 consecutive day shifts · Cumulative	✓ 7 ✓ up to 9 if a cover week falls badly	✓ 6 ✓ up to 9 if a cover week falls badly
More than 55 hours in a week MRSF · More than 55 hours worked in any 7-day period · Cumulative	▲ 60.8	✓ 51.6 ▲ up to 55.9 if a cover week is worked as four 8-hour duties
Long runs of 8-hour shifts MRSF · More than 7 consecutive 8h shifts · Cumulative	✓ 7 ▲ up to 9 if a cover week falls badly	✓ 5
Start times moving earlier through the week FF17 · Backward rotating pattern · Circadian	✓ 10 backward / 12 forward	✓ 9 backward / 15 forward
Changing shift type about once a week FF18 · Rotating pattern of about a week · Circadian	● 20-line rotation · typically 4h 00m a week	● 24-line rotation · typically 4h 47m a week
Start times that jump by more than two hours FF19 · Successive start times varying by more than 2 hours · (definition to confirm) · Circadian	▲ 6	▲ 7
Less than 12 hours between two shifts FF13 · Less than 12h rest in any 24h · Intervals between duties	✓ 0	✓ 0

Also on the list, and applying to neither link: time of day (FF1) · duty length (FF4) · cumulative (MRSF) · night shifts (FF6, FF8, FF9, FF12, FF14, FF16, FF20).

- **Standing factors (●) are recorded for information, not counted.** FF2 comes with the station's 06:20 open, and FF18 — the ORR's concern with a rotation that changes shift type about once a week (Managing rail staff fatigue, 7.68) — comes with every weekly link, which moves everyone one line a week by construction; its week-to-week step is shown as information.
- **How to read the table.** Each mark and figure is for the duties the rota fixes, with the cover weeks left out because their duties are not known yet — for today's link as for the proposal. Where a cover week's four duties could make a row worse, "up to" beneath it gives the worst place they could fall. The MRSF rows are extra checks from the rail industry's guidance on managing staff fatigue, listed beside the ORR's own. FF2 and FF15 use the ORR's early — a start from 05:00 up to 06:59, not the 11:00 used elsewhere on this sheet; the station opens at 06:20, so every link has FF2. FF11 counts shifts between two-day breaks, so a single rest day does not reset it — that is why it can be longer than the most days worked in a row.
- **Cover weeks.** A cover week's four duties can fall in different ways, and on this design that moves the most days worked in a row (6 if placed well), the run of early starts, FF15 (4 if placed well), FF11 (14 if spread out, 9–12 if worked together) and the 55-hour row, which counts a cover week as no hours: 51.6–55.9 if the four are worked as 8-hour duties, which would make it present. Where they fall is for the roster office. This page is an aid to discussion, not a fatigue risk assessment.

Can I trust these numbers?

How firm each figure is, what it is based on, and what no rota can tell you.

Firm

Worked out exactly from the rota, and checked again by the app:

- the rest gaps and the most days in a row
- the 35-hour contract
- full weekends off
- how many people are on duty, hour by hour
- the shift times and their lengths

A guide, not a verdict

Useful for comparing, never a pass or a fail:

- how closely the floor follows the trains
- the fatigue warnings — guidance from the rail regulator
- how familiar the shift times are
- figures “each, a year” — averages over the whole link

Not known yet

No rota can say these; they are for the people who work it and the managers who roster it:

- where each cover week’s four duties fall
- how leave and sickness land
- whether staff accept the new shift times
- Wembley event days — the rota follows the trains, not the crowds
- who starts on which line
- the written source of the 13-day limit

What each figure is based on

Where the figures come from

Every figure is worked out from the rota on page 3 by the Marylebone Roster app, and the same calculation is run on today’s link. None is typed in by hand.

Cover weeks

Marked on all seven days but worked on four, placed by the roster clerk. A cover week counts as a full contracted week and as four days at work. Their shift times are not known yet, so the runs, rest gaps, yearly counts and fatigue warnings are worked out on the fixed duties — the cover weeks left out, and today’s link the same way. Where a cover week’s four duties could make a figure worse, the worst place they could fall is given beside it as “up to”, and the hard limits are tested at that worst case. Whatever is later given in a cover week must still be rostered within the normal limits.

Sundays

Sunday is not in the contract: Sunday duties are overtime, as today. So “days at work” and the 35-hour week are Monday to Saturday. A Sunday off costs no annual leave.

Each person, a year

Every week’s duties, times 52, shared across everyone on the link — Sunday overtime included. “Days at work a year” is Monday to Saturday only: the days a week $\times 365 \div 7$. Somebody’s own year depends on which week they start on.

Following the trains

For each hour, the share of the day’s floor staff is set against the share of the day’s train service in the December 2026 timetable, each train weighted by its length; the differences are squared — so one big mismatch counts far more than several small ones — added up and multiplied by 10,000. 0 would be a perfect match; lower is closer. The staff share uses the minutes each person spends on the floor, finer than the whole-person counts on page 5, where anyone on for part of an hour counts. It measures the shape of the day, not a staffing level: an extra person in a quiet hour makes it worse although nobody is worse off. The ticket office is taken out first: it is staffed to its opening hours, not to the trains, which is why its rows on page 5 carry no match figure.

The ticket office

Run as this design’s author planned it, not as identical pairs: Monday to Friday 06:20 and 07:00 earlies, then 13:30 and 14:00 lates; Saturday two 06:20s, then 13:30 and 14:00; Sunday 07:15 and 08:30, then one late from 14:20, as today. Office staff count as floor only at the quiet ends and once the office has closed (page 5).

Rest, runs and weekends

The shortest gap is the single tightest one in the fixed duties, Saturday into Sunday and line into line included. The most days in a row counts Sunday overtime too; it is given for the fixed duties, with “up to” where a cover week placed as badly as it can be would make it longer, and the 13-day limit is tested at that worst case. A full weekend off is a Saturday off then a Sunday off. The shortest gap is one gap: a rota with many rests of just over 12 hours reads the same as one with none.

Handover

The overlap when one shift takes over from another. The December rules ask for 15 minutes to each closer, and 20 in the ticket office (30 on a Sunday) — page 6.

Familiar shift times

How many of the shift times somebody already works today — a rough guide to how much there is to learn, not to what staff will accept.

Fatigue warnings

The Office of Rail and Road’s good-practice list of roster patterns that tend to tire people, with four rail-industry checks. A warning is a question to discuss, not a breach, and this is not a fatigue risk assessment. Early starts at a 06:20 station and a weekly rotation come with every link, today’s included, so they are recorded on page 7 and not counted. In the ORR’s checks an early start is one from 05:00 up to 06:59 and a “block” of earlies is two or more in a row; the start-time rows count how many times a start moves by more than two hours (a count, not hours); the week-to-week move is the average change in a week’s mean start time, Sundays included and cover weeks left out.

What is confirmed

The December 2026 staffing levels, a 24-person link and the Sunday cover were confirmed verbally on 29 September 2026.

The rota is supplied beside this PDF as Polished-Clean-PC-24-EXT-import.txt, ready to paste into the Links page (Import), which re-runs every check here. The code 12424ed2 in every footer is worked out from the 168 days of the rota and nothing else, so a printout always matches the design it came from.